



BRAD GARD

KEYNOTE SPEAKER · MASTER ELECTRICIAN · TRAINING DIRECTOR, IBEW LOCAL 120

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SAFETY KEYNOTE · A TRUE STORY

The Arc Flash Story

ONE LIVE PANEL, ONE FIREBALL, AND THE GEAR HE ALMOST SKIPPED - **CURRENT DOES NOT CARE ABOUT YOUR PLANS.**

THE TALK

On an ordinary afternoon in 2008, Brad was installing a breaker on a live 600-volt panel at a plant in London, Ontario. Getting his arc-flash gear meant a real hassle - signing out through security, walking to his truck, suiting up, and signing all the way back in - for a job that would take a few minutes. Every reason said skip it. He went and got it anyway.

Minutes later, that panel arced and threw a fireball straight at his face. This is the first-person account of what happened next, the response it brought, and why he is still here to tell it. It is the most visceral case a room will ever hear for wearing the gear, for doing the right thing when no one is watching, and for respecting the one thing on the job that does not respect you back.

WHAT THE ROOM WALKS AWAY WITH

- **Current does not negotiate.** It does not care about your schedule, your plan, or how good a hand you are.
- **PPE is not paperwork.** The gear Brad almost skipped is the only reason this story has a good ending.
- **The decision that saves you** is made before the task starts, not during it.
- **Do it right when it is a hassle,** and when no one would ever know you cut the corner.
- **What an arc flash actually does,** from someone who stood in front of one and walked away.

THE DECISION THAT SAVED HIS FACE

Everything said skip the gear. It meant signing out through security, driving to the truck, suiting up, and signing all the way back in, for a few minutes of work. Brad went and got it anyway. Minutes later, a fireball came off that live panel - right at where his face was.

THE INCIDENT

WHEN	Sept 17, 2008 · 2:00 PM
WHERE	General Dynamics, London, ON
THE JOB	3-pole breaker, installed live
THE PANEL	600 / 347 V
THE RESPONSE	London Fire, ESA, MOL, GD Security
OUTCOME	Walked away. The PPE did its job.

IDEAL FOR

Safety days, stand-downs and summits · Construction and industrial employers · Electrical and high-voltage workforces · Trade associations and unions · Apprenticeship and training programs

FORMATS

Signature keynote	45-60 min
Safety stand-down	20-30 min
Keynote + facilitated debrief	60-90 min

Brad Gard - Master Electrician & Training Director, IBEW Local 120. NCSO, CSA Z462 electrical safety. Four decades in the field, and one afternoon he will never forget. Recent keynote: NETCO, Charlevoix.

BOOK THIS KEYNOTE

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